

Absolutely — **earth** is a particularly strong target because your passage uses it inside a figurative expression:

> “She once told me that when life feels noisy, plants **bring her back to earth**.”

Here **earth** does **not** literally mean soil or the planet. It means returning to a **calmer, more grounded, realistic state of mind**. The word also has major literal meanings involving **the planet, land/ground, soil**, plus important technical and idiomatic uses.

Word family: **earth / earthly / earthy / earthen / earthbound**

Base word: earth

Related forms: earthly, earthy, earthen, earthbound

Useful compounds / expressions: the Earth, on earth, down to earth, bring someone back to earth, earth wire, rare earth, earthenware

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞 , technical)

Your sentence:

> “When life feels noisy, plants **bring her back to earth**.”

Meaning in your passage: **bring someone back to earth = 讓人重新踏實、平靜、回到現實**

Here the image is:

> stress/noise → mentally unsettled

> plants → reconnect her with something simple, real, and grounding

繁體中文 :

讓一個人從壓力、紛亂或過度沉浸的狀態中重新變得踏實、平靜，回到現實

Natural translation:

> “Plants bring her back to earth.”

「植物能讓她**重新平靜下來、腳踏實地，回到當下**。」

So in this passage:

> **back to earth = 回到踏實、平靜、現實的狀態**

1. **the Earth = planet we live on (行星) — 地球**

Capitalization is important.

Practice 1

> “The **Earth** moves around the Sun.”

「**地球**繞著太陽運行。」

Practice 2

> “Most of the Earth’s surface is covered by water.”

「**地球**表面大部分被水覆蓋。」

the Earth = 人類居住的行星；太陽系第三顆行星

Usually capitalized when referring specifically to the planet:

> Earth / the Earth

2. **earth** = land / ground (地面) — 地面；大地；土地

A major literal meaning.

Practice 3

> “The leaves fell to the **earth**.”

「葉子落到**地面 / 大地**上。」

Practice 4

> “He lay on the bare **earth**.”

「他躺在光禿的**地面 / 土地**上。」

earth = 地面的實體土地，與天空、水面等相對

This is somewhat more literary than everyday **ground** in many contexts.

3. **earth** = soil (土壤) — 泥土；土壤

Very important for your plant passage.

Practice 5

> “The seeds were covered with a thin layer of **earth**.”

「種子上覆蓋了一層薄薄的**泥土**。」

Practice 6

> “The earth was dark and rich.”

「那片**土壤**顏色深而且肥沃。」

earth = 植物生長其中的天然泥土 / 土壤

Important:

> earth ≈ soil

but **soil** is more neutral and scientific/agricultural.

4. **earth** = the world / human world (世界) — 世上 ; 人間

A broad figurative extension.

Practice 7

> “There is no place on **earth** quite like this.”

「**世上**沒有另一個地方完全像這裡。」

Practice 8

> “She believes every person on earth deserves respect.”

「她認為**世上每一個人**都值得尊重。」

earth = 人類所生活的世界 / 世間

Common in:

> on earth

> the ends of the earth

5. **on earth (強調疑問) — 到底 ; 究竟**

A very common idiomatic use.

Practice 9

> “What on **earth** are you doing?”

「你**到底**在做甚麼？」

Practice 10

> “Why on earth would he say that?”

「他**究竟**為甚麼會那樣說？」

on earth = 用來加強疑問、驚訝、不解或強烈情緒

Here **earth** no longer means literal land.

6. **bring someone back to earth (比喻) — 讓某人回到現實 ; 重新踏實**

Your exact source expression.

Practice 11 — Original

> “Plants **bring her back to earth**.”

「植物讓她**重新平靜、踏實，回到現實**。」

Practice 12

> “The disappointing result brought him back to earth.”

「那個令人失望的結果讓他**從過度樂觀中回到現實**。」

Practice 13

> “A quiet walk helps bring me back to earth after a stressful day.”

「壓力很大的一天過後，安靜散步能讓我**重新平靜下來、腳踏實地**。」

bring someone back to earth = 讓某人離開過度興奮、幻想、壓力或精神飄忽的狀態，重新面對現實 / 保持踏實

The exact Chinese changes with context.

7. **come back down to earth (比喻) — 回到現實；冷靜下來**

Closely related fixed expression.

Practice 14

> “After the excitement of winning, she slowly came back down to earth.”

「勝出後的興奮過去，她慢慢**冷靜下來、回到現實**。」

Practice 15

> “He needs to come back down to earth and think realistically.”

「他需要**回到現實**，實際地想一想。」

come back down to earth = 從興奮、幻想或不切實際的狀態回復現實

8. **down-to-earth = practical / realistic / unpretentious — 實際的；腳踏實地的；平易近人的**

A major lexicalized adjective.

Practice 16

> “She is very **down-to-earth** despite her success.”

「儘管她很成功，她仍然非常**平易近人、腳踏實地**。」

Practice 17

> “He gave us some down-to-earth advice.”

「他給了我們一些很**實際、不空泛的建議**。」

down-to-earth = 實際、不浮誇、不脫離現實；形容人時也常帶有平易近人的意思

Important:

> down-to-earth person

> = 腳踏實地 / 平易近人的人

9. **earth = electrical ground connection (電力) — 接地；地線**

A major technical British-English sense.

Practice 18

> “The appliance must be connected to **earth**.”

「這件電器必須**接地**。」

Practice 19

> “Check that the earth wire is connected properly.”

「檢查**地線**是否正確連接。」

earth — electrical = 把電路與大地 / 接地系統連接，以提供安全電流路徑

Regional note:

* British English: **earth**

* American English: **ground**

10. **earth + electrical object (動詞) — 把.....接地**

Now **earth** can be a verb.

Practice 20

> “The metal casing must be properly **earthed**.”

「金屬外殼必須妥善**接地**。」

Practice 21

> “The electrician earthed the system before testing it.”

「電工在測試前先把系統**接地**。」

****earth — verb = 把電氣設備接駁至接地系統****

Especially British English.

11. ****earth = den of a fox/badger (動物) — 狐狸 / 獾的地穴****

An established but secondary meaning.

Practice 22

> “The fox disappeared into its ****earth****.”

「狐狸鑽進自己的****地穴****。」

Practice 23

> “The badgers returned to the earth before sunrise.”

「獾在日出前回到****地穴****。」

****earth — animal den = 狐狸、獾等動物居住的地下洞穴****

Register: countryside/hunting/natural-history vocabulary; not a core everyday sense.

12. ****earthly = relating to life on Earth / this world — 地上的 ; 人世間的****

A useful related adjective.

Practice 24

> “They were concerned with ****earthly**** matters.”

「他們關心的是****人世間 / 現實生活中的事情****。」

Practice 25

> “The poem contrasts earthly life with the spiritual world.”

「這首詩把****人世生活****與精神世界作對比。」

****earthly = 與地球上的現實生活 / 人世間有關的****

Often contrasts with:

* heavenly

* spiritual

* divine

13. ****earthly = possible / imaginable in this world (加強語氣) — 世間可能的 ; 到底有的****

Usually in emphatic expressions.

Practice 26

> “There was no ****earthly**** reason for him to leave.”

「他根本沒有任何****合理 / 可能的理由****離開。」

Practice 27

> “I have no earthly idea where she went.”

「我****完全不知道****她去了哪裡。」

****earthly — emphatic = 用來加強「完全沒有 / 根本沒有」等意思****

This is somewhat idiomatic.

14. ****earthy = resembling soil / earth (土味) — 泥土般的 ; 土壤氣味的****

Practice 28

> “The mushrooms had a rich, ****earthy**** smell.”

「那些蘑菇帶有濃郁的****泥土氣息****。」

Practice 29

> “The wine has an earthy flavour.”

「這款酒帶有****泥土般、自然厚實的風味****。」

****earthy = 味道、氣味或顏色令人聯想到泥土、森林地面等自然氣息****

15. ****earthy = natural / unrefined / direct (人物 / 風格) — 樸實的；自然不造作的；粗獷直接的****

A figurative extension.

Practice 30

> “She has an ****earthy**** sense of humour.”

「她的幽默感比較****直接、粗獷、不拘小節****。」

Practice 31

> “The restaurant has a warm, earthy style.”

「這家餐廳帶有一種溫暖、****自然樸實****的風格。」

****earthy — figurative = 自然、質樸、不過度精緻；某些語境亦可指幽默 / 語言粗俗直接****

Context is important:

* earthy design = 自然樸實

* earthy humour = 較粗俗直接

16. ****earthen = made of earth/clay — 泥土製的；陶土製的****

Practice 32

> “Water was stored in an ****earthen**** pot.”

「水儲存在一個****陶土製的罐子****裡。」

Practice 33

> “The village had simple earthen walls.”

「村裡有一些簡單的****泥土牆****。」

****earthen = 由泥土、黏土等天然土質材料製成的****

17. **earthenware = pottery made from fired clay — 陶器；陶土器皿**

Practice 34

> “The museum displays ancient **earthenware**.”

「博物館展出古代**陶器**。」

Practice 35

> “The bowl is made of earthenware.”

「這隻碗是用**陶土**燒製的。」

earthenware = 以較低溫燒製的陶土器皿 / 陶器類材料

Useful family extension.

18. **earthbound = unable to leave the ground / confined to Earth — 留在地面的；受限於地球的**

Practice 36

> “Humans were once entirely **earthbound**.”

「人類曾經完全**只能在地面活動 / 受限於地球**。」

Practice 37

> “Unlike birds, the animal is earthbound.”

「不像鳥類，這種動物**只能在地面活動**。」

earthbound = 不能離開地面，或受到地球環境限制的

19. **earthbound = ordinary / practical rather than spiritual or imaginative — 世俗的；平凡現實的**

A figurative branch.

Practice 38

> “The story combines fantasy with more earthbound concerns.”

「這個故事把幻想與較**現實、世俗的問題**結合起來。」

Practice 39

> “His ambitions were surprisingly earthbound.”

「他的抱負出奇地**務實、現實**。」

earthbound — figurative = 集中於現實、物質或日常事務，而非超脫 / 幻想層面的

20. **rare earth / rare-earth element (化學 / 科技) — 稀土；稀土元素**

A very important modern technical compound.

Practice 40

> “Rare-earth elements are used in many electronic devices.”

「**稀土元素**被廣泛用於電子設備。」

Practice 41

> “The country has large reserves of rare earths.”

「該國擁有大量**稀土資源**。」

rare earth(s) = 一組具有相似化學性質、在高科技產業中用途廣泛的元素

Important learner warning:

> **rare earth** does not simply mean “rare soil.”

It is a technical chemical term.

21. **earth tone / earth colour (設計) — 大地色；自然土色**

A common design/fashion compound.

Practice 42

> “The room is decorated in warm **earth tones**.”

「房間以溫暖的**大地色系**裝飾。」

Practice 43

> “She prefers clothes in earth colours.”

「她較喜歡穿**大地色系**的衣服。」

earth tones = 模仿泥土、石頭、沙、植物等自然色彩的棕、米、橄欖綠等柔和色系

Important distinction: **Earth vs earth**

Earth

capitalized:

= the planet

> “Earth orbits the Sun.”

earth

lowercase:

can mean:

* soil

* ground

* the world

* electrical earth

This capitalization distinction is highly testable.

Important distinction: **earth vs ground**

ground

the ordinary everyday word for the surface under your feet.

earth

can mean natural ground/soil and often sounds more literary or material-focused.

> “Sit on the ground.”

natural everyday English.

> “Seeds push through the earth.”

more natural when emphasizing soil.

Important distinction: **earth vs soil**

earth

broad/common:
natural soil/ground.

soil

more precise:
material in which plants grow; common in gardening/science.

> rich soil

> = 肥沃土壤

> dig in the earth

> = 挖泥土

In your gardening passage, **soil** would normally be the more technical gardening word.

Important distinction: **earth vs land**

earth

can refer to soil/ground or the whole world.

land

often means:

- * dry ground rather than sea;
- * an area of property/territory.

> land ownership
> = 土地所有權

not usually:

> *earth ownership*

Important distinction: **Earth vs world**

Earth

the physical planet.

world

can mean:

- * Earth;
- * human society;
- * a particular sphere/domain.

> “the world of business”

cannot be replaced naturally by:

> *the Earth of business*

Important distinction: **bring back to earth vs calm down**

calm down

= become less angry, excited, nervous, etc.

bring someone back to earth

= make someone more grounded, realistic, or mentally settled.

In your passage, **bring her back to earth** has a warmer, more reflective idea:

> gardening reconnects her with something real and simple.

Important distinction: ****bring back to earth vs down-to-earth****

****bring someone back to earth****

verb expression:

= 讓某人回到現實 / 重新踏實

****down-to-earth****

adjective:

= 腳踏實地的 / 實際的 / 平易近人的

> “Gardening brings her back to earth.”

vs

> “She is a down-to-earth person.”

Important distinction: ****earthly vs earthy****

This is a major learner trap.

****earthly****

= relating to this world / human life.

> earthly concerns

> = 人世間的事務

****earthy****

= soil-like / natural / rustic / sometimes blunt.

> earthy smell

> = 泥土氣味

> earthy humour

> = 粗獷直接的幽默

They are ****not interchangeable****.

Important distinction: **earthy vs earthen**

earthy

describes character/smell/style:

> earthy smell

> = 泥土氣息

earthen

describes material:

> earthen pot

> = 泥土 / 陶土製的罐

So:

> **earthy = 像泥土 / 自然樸實的**

> **earthen = 用泥土製成的**

Important distinction: **earth vs rare earth**

earth

= 地球 / 泥土 / 地面

rare earth

= 稀土元素

This is a technical lexicalized compound and should not be translated word-for-word.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **Earth — planet** = 地球

* **earth — ground/land** = 地面 / 大地

* **earth — soil** = 泥土 / 土壤
 * **earth — world** = 世上 / 人間
 * **on earth** = 到底 / 究竟
 * **bring someone back to earth** = 讓某人重新踏實 / 回到現實
 * **come back down to earth** = 回到現實 / 冷靜下來
 * **down-to-earth** = 腳踏實地 / 平易近人
 * **earth — electrical** = 接地 / 地線
 * **earth — verb** = 把電氣設備接地
 * **earth — animal den** = 狐狸 / 獾等的地下洞穴
 * **earthly** = 人世間的 / 現世的
 * **earthy — smell/flavour** = 泥土般自然氣息
 * **earthy — style/personality** = 自然樸實 / 粗獷直接
 * **earthen** = 泥土 / 陶土製的
 * **earthenware** = 陶器
 * **earthbound — literal** = 只能留在地面 / 受限於地球
 * **earthbound — figurative** = 世俗 / 現實的
 * **rare earth** = 稀土
 * **earth tones** = 大地色系

This is close to the useful modern ceiling without drifting into obsolete or highly specialist geology terminology.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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Earth — planet	人類居住的太陽系第三顆行星；地球
earth — ground	與天空、水面等相對的天然地面 / 大地
earth — soil	植物生長其中的天然泥土 / 土壤
earth — world	人類生活的世界 / 世間
on earth	用來加強疑問、驚訝或不解；到底 / 究竟
bring someone back to earth	讓某人從興奮、幻想、壓力或精神紛亂中重新變得踏實、平靜、現實
come back down to earth	從過度興奮 / 不切實際狀態重新回到現實
down-to-earth	實際、腳踏實地、不浮誇；亦可指平易近人
earth — electrical	把電路與接地系統相連，以提供安全電流路徑
earth — animal den	狐狸、獾等動物居住的地下洞穴
earthly	與地球上的現實生活 / 人世間有關的
earthy — literal	味道、氣味或顏色帶有泥土般的自然特徵
earthy — figurative	自然樸實、不造作；某些語境可指粗獷直接
earthen	由泥土、黏土等土質材料製成的
earthenware	以陶土燒製的器皿 / 材料
earthbound — literal	不能離開地面或受限於地球的
earthbound — figurative	集中於日常現實 / 世俗事務的

rare earth	一組具有相似化學性質、廣泛用於高科技產業的稀土元素	
earth tones	模仿泥土、沙、石頭等自然色彩的大地色系	

For your original sentence

> “When life feels noisy, plants **bring her back to earth**.”

The exact meaning is:

****bring her back to earth = 讓她從忙亂、壓力和精神上的嘈雜感中重新平靜、踏實，回到當下與現實****

So the most natural translation is:

> ****「她說，當生活讓她覺得很嘈雜、很紛亂時，植物會讓她重新平靜下來、腳踏實地。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****Earth**** → 地球
- > ****earth**** → 泥土 / 大地
- > ****on earth**** → 到底 / 究竟
- > ****back to earth**** → 回到現實 / 重新踏實
- > ****down-to-earth**** → 腳踏實地 / 平易近人
- > ****earthy**** → 泥土般的 / 自然樸實的
- > ****earthen**** → 泥土 / 陶土製的
- > ****earth** (electrical)** → 接地
- > ****rare earth**** → 稀土